

Skewers reverse the target order

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

A skewer attacks a valuable piece in front of a second target on the same line. When the front piece moves, the rear target may fall. Kings make especially forcing front targets because check must be answered.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A rook check along a rank may drive the king away and expose a queen behind it. But the defender may block the check, capture the rook, or move the king while creating protection for the rear piece.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What makes a skewer succeed?

ANSWER AND REASONING

A useful alignment, a forcing attack on the front target, and no defense that saves the rear target without unacceptable loss. Trace the full line and calculate alternatives.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Aligned pieces become vulnerable when the front one must move.